

TC001

Live-Thread Follow-Ups

Ask about the most alive, emotionally charged, or meaningful part of what someone just said.

🎯IMPACT
Very high

📊DIFFICULTY
Easy-Med

⚠️MAIN RISK
Interviewer energy if you never contribute

EXAMPLE DIALOGUE

✖ POOR VERSION (self-shifts too soon) Person: "I just started a new job." You: "Nice. How has that first week been?" Person: "It's been busy but good." You: "That's great. Anyway, my boss was awful." • Turns back to you too quickly. • Misses the emotional opening. • Creates parallel monologues.	✔ BETTER VERSION (follows the thread) Person: "I just started a new job." You: "Nice. What's been the most intense part so far?" Person: "The learning, but the first week was overwhelming." You: "Overwhelming how - new tech, people, or both?" Person: "Both. I'm still finding my rhythm." You: "Got it. What's helped you feel a bit more settled?"	☆ ADVANCED VERSION (charismatic flow) Person: "I just started a new job." You: "Nice. What's been the most intense part so far?" Person: "The people. So many different styles." You: "That can be a lot. Who's one person that's stood out - in a good or surprising way?" Person: "Actually, the mentor I got. Didn't expect that." You: "That's the kind of surprise that shifts everything."
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NATURALNESS RULE

Use **comment -> question, not question -> question**. A comment makes curiosity feel warm.

Example: "That sounds like the interesting part. What happened there?"

AFTER 1-2 FOLLOW-UPS

Contribute something small: a reflection, related thought, or short self-disclosure. Otherwise the conversation can feel like an interview.

MINIMUM VIABLE VERSION

Pick the emotionally loaded word and ask: **"[word] how?"**

Examples: "Weird how?" "Intense how?" "Unexpected how?"

MISTAKES, CALIBRATION AND RECOVERY

✖ COMMON MISTAKES • Naked questions: "Why?" "How?" • Question-stacking: too many at once. • Following facts, not energy: "Where was it?" • Going too deep too early: "What did that reveal about you?" • Self-shifting too soon: "That happened to me too..." • Sounding clinical: "How did this impact you emotionally?" • Never contributing: only asking questions.	✔ SIGNS IT IS WORKING • Longer answers. • Warmer tone. • More animation or detail. • They ask you questions back. • They laugh or soften. • They say "Exactly" or "That's what I mean."	⚠ STOP OR ADJUST • Short answers. • Flat tone. • Looking away or checking phone. • Topic changes. • They seem pressured or analysed. • You asked three questions without sharing.	🔄 RECOVERY PHRASES • "I'm asking because it sounded interesting, not because I'm interrogating you." • "No pressure if you'd rather not get into it." • "That came out more intense than I meant." • "Let me ask that in a less clunky way." • "I got curious there. My bad." • "I'll stop making you do all the talking."
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↔ **BEST PAIRED WITH**

- **Rapport chain** - build connection and ease.
- **Conflict chain** - repair and realign.
- **Influence chain** - move toward values and decisions.
- **Charisma chain** - keep it playful and human.

↔ **TECHNIQUE CHAIN EXAMPLES**

Rapport: warm comment -> follow-up -> reflection -> self-disclosure -> appreciation

Influence: understand goal -> follow-up -> values -> frame suggestion -> release pressure

Conflict: validate -> follow-up -> clarify need -> propose next step

Charisma: playful observation -> follow-up -> reflection -> light humour

⚠ **FIELD TIP**

Follow emotional energy, not just information.

Look for: "I'm so...", "Honestly...", "The weird part is...", "What was I thinking?"

Ask: "Weird how?"

🎯 **PRACTICE DRILL**

1. One warm comment before asking.
2. One short, connected question.
3. One reflection before you share.

✔ **30-SECOND QUALITY CHECK**

- Was my worded callout aimed at energy?
- Did I comment before asking?
- Was my question short and connected?
- Am I matching the right depth?

- Did I reflect briefly?
- Did I contribute after one or two follow-ups?
- Did they seem more open, detailed, or engaged?
- Did I stop before it became interview-like?